



“I think one of the things is that investors around the world realise that they cannot depend only on the US. So, you’ll see more money flowing into emerging markets. And India is at the top of the list”

Q: What sectors do you hope to capitalise on in India?

A: First of all, the defence sector is something we have to look at in view of what’s happening with Pakistan. I think the Indian government will be spending more money in that direction. The second area would be in technology companies—those that are producing software not only for domestic use, but export. The third sector is housing. We believe there’s going to be greater demand for housing in India.

Q: What is your outlook on gold?

A: I have been talking about gold for quite some time, and you’ve heard me say that people should allocate at least 10% of their portfolio to gold. I keep physical gold, and I think everyone should have it. Now, the question is when to buy. No one knows what the price is going to be tomorrow, next week, or the week after.

Q: Would it be fair to say that foreign institutional investors (FIIs) are back for good in the Indian markets?

A: Yes. You must remember that there are two types of foreign investors. One is companies that are investing in plants to produce in India. The other is portfolio investing where people are going into the stock market. I expect both to increase, but the former, in other words, companies that are building plants in India, will be much, much larger going forward.

Q: What’s your sense on possible market levels in India this year?

A: I think the Indian market will go up further from where it is now and I think you’re going to have a continuing bull market with corrections along the way.

Q: What are the next possible triggers for the global and Indian markets?

A: Well, globally, peace in Ukraine, number one, and peace in the Middle East with Iran giving up the nuclear option are the two areas that are going to look good under Trump. And then, specifically for India, tensions with Pakistan will always be there, but the good news is now we have a ceasefire and hopefully we can keep things on an even keel. And if Pakistan can pull itself up economically, that would be very, very beneficial for everybody concerned. **BT**

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